Arc quick reference

TOOLS (LEFT BAR)

`V`	Select
`E`	Measuring tape
`W`	Wall
`R`	Room (four walls at once)
`D` / `N`	Door / Window
`S`	Stairs
`A`	Floors & baseboards
`O`	Outdoor: patios, decks, fences, lot lines
`U`	MEP: ducts, pipes & wires
`F` / `G`	Roof / Porch
`K`	Paint & materials
`Y`	Decorate (colour palettes)
`B`	Blocks: furniture, cabinets, fixtures
`M` / `C`	Move / Duplicate
`Q` / `X`	Rotate / Mirror
`Del`	Delete what's selected

The letter in each tool's corner is its key. The status bar at the bottom always says what to click next.

EVERYDAY KEYS

`Esc`	Finish or cancel; back to Select
`Enter`	Use the size you typed
`Ctrl`+`Z` / `Y`	Undo / Redo
`Ctrl`+`S` / `P`	Save / print this floor plan
`Ctrl`+`L`	Lock the selection (click it to unlock)
`Ctrl`+`C` `V` `X`	Copy, paste (into any plan), cut
`Ctrl`+`K`	Search for any command
`Ctrl`+`,`	Preferences
`Z`	Zoom to fit the plan
`F`	While drawing: flip the wall's side, or a door's hinge
`D`	Measuring: keep the last leg as a dimension
`Shift`+click	Add to (or take from) the selection

TYPING SIZES

While a tool waits for a click, just type, then press `Enter`. It shows in the **Size** box.

`14'6"` `14'-6"`	Feet and inches
`14' 6 1/2"`	With fractions
`174"` `14.5'`	All inches, or decimal feet
`3600mm` `3.6m`	Metric works in any plan
`12'<45`	Wall or line: length at an angle
`32' x 24'`	Room: width by depth
`2'6"`	Door or window: distance from the blue end

DRAWING WALLS AND ROOMS

- **Wall**: click the start, then each corner. Right-click, double-click or `Esc` to stop. Click the first corner to close a room.
- Rooms are found by themselves when walls close a space. Select one to name it and set its floor and ceiling.
- Drag a wall to push it; drag a blue grip to move an end.
- **Snap** ▾: angle lock, Snap to walls, Round to, ft-in or mm. Hold `Shift` to free the angle for a moment.

DOORS AND WINDOWS

- Hover over a wall to see the distance to each end; click to place.
- The door swings to the side your cursor is on; `F` flips the hinge.
- **Several at once** (panel): set **How many**, then Equal sections, Equal gaps, Centred on the wall, From the end, or From where I click. One click places them all.

SELECTING

- Click to select; the panel on the right shows its settings.
- Drag a box **left → right**: things fully inside. **Right → left**: anything it touches.
- Nothing selected: the panel shows the **Project** and the **Design check**.

MOVING AROUND THE PLAN

Wheel	Zoom toward the cursor
Right / middle drag	Pan
`Space` + drag	Pan
`Z`	Zoom to fit (or the corners icon on the top bar)

IPAD: FINGERS AND PENCIL

Pencil	Draws; hover to see the preview; double-tap for Select
One finger	Pans and taps to select once a Pencil is used (draws before that, or with Fingers draw on)
Two fingers	Pan and pinch to zoom
Two-finger tap	Undo
Long press	Right-click (finish a wall)

THE 3D VIEW

Drag	Orbit (one finger)
Right drag	Pan (two fingers)
Wheel	Zoom (pinch)
Double-click	Centre on that spot
Go inside…	Stand in a room: drag to look, wheel to step
Walk	`W` `A` `S` `D` or arrows, drag to look, `F` flies, `Esc` stops
Compass	Click a letter for a square view

View list: Full model, Framing, MEP, Roof off, X-ray, Wireframe. **Sun** for real shadows, **Render** for a photo-like picture.

TOP BAR MENUS

File	New, templates, open, samples, save, project settings, imports (DXF, PDF, scans, DWG)
Export	Render, PDF, DXF, 3D models, 3D printing, DWG, IFC, the takeoff spreadsheet
Design	Present it, style packs, exterior looks, design options, kitchens, closets, room layouts, furnish
Review	Design check, specs, code summary, schedules, the permit set, questions for the builder
Budget	The estimate, the shopping list, trades, quotes and the timeline
View	What 3D shows; plan overlays
Draw	Lines, text, hatch, dimensions, 3D shapes, sections, terraces
Modify	Offset, trim, fillet, array, align, copy & paste
Snap, Show	Units and snapping; dimensions, grid, floor patterns, wall fill
Sheets	Drawing sheets with a title block, to PDF
Guide	Video and hands-on lessons, the user guide, this card

AUTOCAD KEYS (BUTTON, BOTTOM RIGHT)

`L PL REC C A`	Line, polyline, rectangle, circle, arc
`H DIM T`	Hatch, dimension, text
`M CO RO MI SC`	Move, duplicate, rotate, mirror, scale
`O TR EX F AR`	Offset, trim, extend, fillet, array
`W I BOX`	Wall, insert a block, 3D shape
`E U Z`	Erase, undo, zoom to fit
`PLOT TAKEOFF`	PDF, takeoff & costs

Type the letters, then `Enter` or `Space`. `Space` alone repeats the last command.

3D PRINTING AND PHOTOS

3D Print	Top bar: the workspace, in seven sections
1 · 2	Printer and bed · model ground, plates, colour change
3 · 4	Surfaces (cobbles, bricks) · printed inserts and snow
5 · 6 · 7	Parts list and $ · check and save · watch-outs
Fit test	Section 1: tab, pegs and colour step to print first
Photo eraser	Export ▾ → Touch up a photo: brush, then Erase

GETTING HELP

- `Ctrl`+`K`: type what you want to do (`stairs` , `pdf` , `sofa`).
- **?** on a panel heading opens the guide at that topic.
- **Guide** ▾ on the top bar: every video lesson, the hands-on lessons and the user guide.
- **Guide** ▾ → **Hands-on lessons…**: build a small house step by step.
- **Video lessons**: short videos, start to finish.
- **File** ▾ → **Samples…**: finished plans to explore.

Design check warnings: **Show** finds it, **Ignore** sets it aside, **Note** keeps your reason with the plan.

Code checks are a guide for early design; a licensed professional and the building official have the final say.